



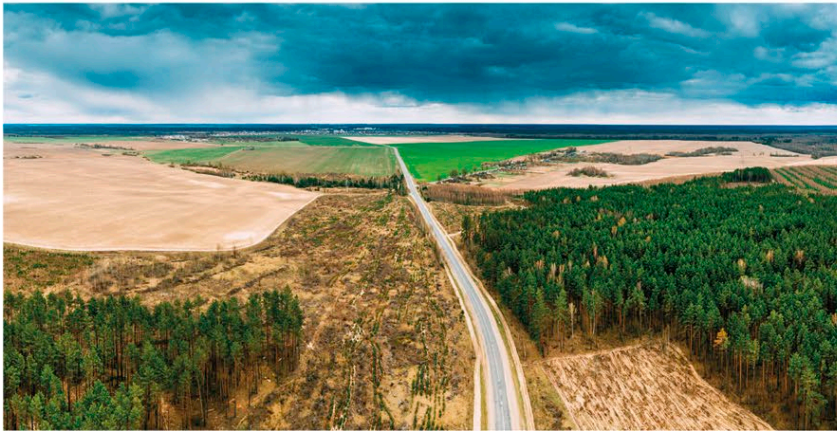
Deforestation

Trees are felled to clear land for crops and livestock, or to develop buildings, dams, and open up mines. Their timber is also sold to make products, such as paper. An estimated 15 billion trees are cut down each year, resulting in the loss of forest habitats for animals and plants.



Climate change

Burning fossil fuels, such as coal, releases carbon dioxide and other greenhouse gases into the atmosphere. The increasing levels of these gases is causing the world to warm up, threatening habitats on land and in the oceans, including the vital polar ice habitat of penguins.



Building on the wilderness

When humans build towns, cities, and roads, they are carving up the wilderness to leave smaller and smaller patches of natural habitat. Some animals, such as predators that are high up in the food chain, need large areas in which to roam. They cannot survive in the isolated patches of habitat that remain.



Overfishing

Some fish are under threat because so many are taken out of the ocean that their numbers cannot recover. Other species are caught up in nets and discarded as unwanted bycatch. The sharks pictured here have been targeted for their fins, considered a delicacy in some countries.

Poaching

Many kinds of wild animals are hunted for their meat, or because their bodies supply something that is considered valuable. Elephants have long been targeted for their ivory tusks, and rhinoceroses for their horns. This is illegal but it still takes place, driving some species to the edge of extinction.



**AN AREA OF RAINFOREST
ALMOST THE SIZE OF
SWITZERLAND WAS
LOST DURING 2019 ALONE**



**OF MAMMALS
ARE THREATENED
BY EXTINCTION**